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Taojie Wang

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Research Areas

Area of Specialization: Ethics, Moral Psychology, Philosophy of Action

Area of Competence: Ancient Greek Philosophy, Classical Chinese Philosophy, Philosophy of AI

Academic Appointments

Teaching Associate, Department of Philosophy, **Boston University**

2026–present

Education

Ph.D. in Philosophy, **Brown University**

2019–2026

Dissertation: *Aspects of Love*

Committee: Nomy Arpaly (Chair), Jamie Dreier, Emily Kress, Bernard Reginster

Abstract: I argue that being connected with another person is not a relation to anything about them, defending this claim through three questions: what loving someone consists in, when a desire is intelligible to us, and how we are transformed by other people. The upshot is a challenge to a pattern that runs through several literatures at once: theories that identify an interpersonal relation with a relation to some item a person has (e.g., their well-being, their ends, the desirability of what they want, their rational capacities), and thereby lose the person themselves. Such theories cannot explain loving a dead friend, finding another’s desire intelligible without seeing the good in the desire, or being transformed by someone who never argues with us. I offer an alternative on which these connections consist in forms of interpersonal sharing: sharing a practical stance, sharing a mutually recognized practice, and what I call interpersonal resonance.

Sc.M. in Computer Science, **Brown University**

2023–2026

Coursework: Artificial Intelligence, Deep Learning, Computational Linguistics, Human Factors in Cybersecurity; independent research in natural language understanding (with Ellie Pavlick).

M.A. in Philosophy, **University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee**

2017–2019

B.A. in Philosophy, *magna cum laude*, **KU Leuven**

2016–2017

B.A. in English (Hon.), **University of Liverpool**

2012–2016

Research

In Progress:

‘Intelligibility and Articulative Normality’ (under review, draft available upon request)

‘Influence and Resonance’ (draft available upon request)

‘The Stance of Love’ (draft available upon request)

Conference Presentations (*all peer-reviewed unless noted otherwise*)

‘Influence and Resonance’

Eastern APA (Boston), colloquium talk, January 2027.

The 29th Rocky Mountain Ethics Congress, poster session, University of Colorado, Boulder, Aug. 2026.

‘Loneliness, Solitude, and the Capacity for Self-Knowledge’

“Loneliness”: the 7th International Interdisciplinary Conference, University of Gdańsk (online), Sept. 2025.

‘Love in the Absence of the Other: Death and Love’s Stance’

The 28th Rocky Mountain Ethics Congress, poster session, University of Colorado, Boulder, Aug. 2025.

The Summer School on Iris Murdoch’s Philosophy, University of Vienna, Jul. 2025.

Comments on John Sweeney’s *The Value of Immersive Desiring*

The 28th Rocky Mountain Ethics Congress, University of Colorado, Boulder, Aug. 2025.

Comments on Macy Salzberger’s *Alienated Love*

Love and Loneliness, California State University, San Bernardino, Dec. 2024.

‘This Is Simply What I Do: Primitive Normativity on Following a Rule’

The Capital Conference on Analytic Philosophy, Beijing Normal University, Nov. 2019.

Teaching Experience

As Primary Instructor

Unraveling the “Magic” of AI: Better AI Decisions with Awareness and Agency, Summer 2026 (Brown Pre-College Program, with Len Sprague)

Introduction to Classical Chinese Philosophy, Spring 2025

Love: A Survey in the History of Philosophy, Spring 2023

Contemporary Moral Issues, Summer 2022 (Brown Pre-College Program)

As Teaching Assistant — twelve appointments across eight courses

Brown University (2020–26): *Philosophy of Law* (Estlund); *Ancient Greek Philosophy* (Gill); *Hellenistic Philosophy* (Kress); *Free Speech* (Estlund); *Psychology and Philosophy of Happiness* (Reginster and Krueger); *Political Philosophy* (Estlund).

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee (2017–19): *Introduction to Logic: Critical Reasoning* (Knachel); *Ethical Issues in Health Care: Biomedical Ethics for the 21st Century* (Silverstein).

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Paris Kanellakis Graduate Fellowship, Brown University, 2023–24

Brown University Graduate School Fellowship, Brown University, 2019–20

Brown University Graduate School Research Travel Award, 2019

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee Chancellor’s Award, 2017

Service

Mentor: Summer Immersion Program in Philosophy at Brown University (SIPP, 2024)

Brown Philosophy Department Events Committee (organizing colloquium talks and invited lectures, 2021–24)

Conference referee: Mark L. Shapiro Graduate Conference at Brown (2020–24)

Languages

Mandarin Chinese (native)

English (fluent)

Ancient Greek (intermediate, reading; coursework at Harvard and Brown, including Greek-language seminars and reading groups)

German (elementary, reading)

References

Nomy Arpaly (Chair)

Professor of Philosophy

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Jamie Dreier

Judy C. Lewent and Mark L. Shapiro

Professor of Philosophy

Brown University

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Emily Kress

William A. Dyer Jr. Assistant Professor of the Humanities

Brown University

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Bernard Reginster

Romeo Elton Professor of Natural Theology

Brown University

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